



WORKPLACE
EDGE

CONFLICT ISN'T A THREAT

Learner Worksheets, Activities & Practice Guide

Navigating healthy tension and
disagreement



Name: _____

Date: _____

Tone Adjustment Tool: Say It Your Way

Conflict respectful language is most effective when it matches your tone, audience, and communication channel. Use this tool to adjust your phrasing for clarity, warmth, and cultural context.

Purpose	Formal / Senior Audience	Peer-Friendly / Conversational	Email / Written
Raise a concern	"I'd like to surface a potential risk before we proceed."	"Something's not sitting right—can we pause?"	Flagging a risk that might need a second look."
Signal misalignment	"I sense we may not be fully aligned—could we clarify?"	"Feels like we're not quite on the same page."	Quick check—are we aligned on this direction?"
Invite shared reflection	Would it be helpful to revisit our assumptions here?"	"Can we sanity-check this together?"	Worth re-checking if our assumptions still hold?"
De-escalate tension	Let's explore the tension here before we move forward."	I can feel some heat—what's underneath that?"	Naming some tension—open to thoughts on what's behind it."

Tone Self-Check Prompts:

- How would this sound if I were receiving it?
- Does it match the formality of our usual communication?
- Does it sound curious, or defensive?



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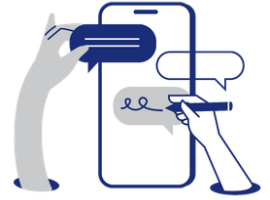
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Conflict Curious Micro-Journal

A. Notice the Moment

Think of a recent moment where you felt disagreement or tension.

- What was happening?
- What did you notice (tone, body language, silence)?
- Did you speak up or stay quiet? Why?



B. Rewind the Moment

If you could try again, what might you say differently?

- What could a curious response sound like?
- (Example: "I think we see this differently — can we talk about it?")
- Write your version in your own voice:



C. Reflect on Impact

- What might the other person have needed (agreement, honesty, clarity)?
- What made it easier or harder to respond respectfully?
- What will you try next time?



D. Spot Patterns

- When do you usually avoid speaking up?
- When do you lean into disagreement?
- What would help you feel more confident?



Weekly Habit (Optional)

Each day, write down one small disagreement and answer:
"What would a conflict-curious response sound like?"